

Daily Briefing

Sunday, August 2, 2026

Calendar

No events found on either Google Calendar (dennismodrak@gmail.com) or Outlook/Microsoft 365 (dennis@modrakcpa.com) for today.

Newsletter Summaries

The four priority tax & accounting sources, read in full and summarized below.

Bradford Tax Institute

"A Complete 2026 Health Insurance Update for S Corporation Owners" — Aug 1, 2026

The piece confirms the S-corp health insurance deduction is still available in 2026, but warns that a single missed reporting step can wipe it out even when every premium was paid correctly. It flags two frequently overlooked traps: the Box 5 Medicare-wages limitation and the family-attribution rule, either of which can void an otherwise valid deduction. It also cautions that S corps reimbursing employees for individual health insurance must use the correct funding arrangement — getting it wrong can expose the business to a penalty of up to \$36,500 per employee, per year.

Checkpoint (Thomson Reuters)

"Checkpoint News — Week of 7/27/2026" — forwarded Aug 1, 2026 (incl. attachment Checkpoint_News.html)

Top story: Grant Thornton Advisors agreed to buy CBIZ for \$5 billion in cash, a deal that would make Grant Thornton the fifth-largest U.S. provider of professional, tax, and advisory services behind only the Big Four. On the legislative side, the Senate Finance Committee advanced the bipartisan Taxpayer Assistance and Service (TAS) Act to modernize the IRS, strengthen taxpayer rights, and regulate paid preparers. The IRS has killed the First Time Abate penalty-relief program, replacing it with a new "Automatic Exemption," and a slate of new FASB rules led by an expense-disaggregation standard take effect in 2027, giving companies about five months to determine if they're affected. On the tax-controversy side, the Tax Court denied interest abatement in an ERC-related case and upheld the SRLY limitation on inherited NOLs (the "lonely parent" rule doesn't apply). In the state roundup: Louisiana set a September 4 deadline to claim \$17.5 million in unclaimed state tax refunds, New York City began notifying property owners subject to its new non-primary-residence ("pied-à-terre") surcharge, and a Wisconsin P.L. 86-272 nexus case involving a Florida-based travel company is headed to the U.S. Supreme Court. The attached Checkpoint_News.html file contains the same weekly digest as the forwarded email body — no additional content beyond what's summarized here.

Accounting Today

"Best of the Week" digest — Aug 1, 2026

This week's roundup is led by the same Grant Thornton–CBIZ \$5 billion acquisition story, framed here as reshaping the competitive landscape just below the Big Four. Other featured pieces: a look at the profession's "missing middle" — the gap in mid-size firm growth and staffing — a piece on driving double-digit firm growth, and confirmation that the IRS has replaced First Time Abate with the new Automatic Exemption. A companion article poses "three questions your firm needs to answer," tied to a promoted growth-strategy conference (Firm

Growth Forum East).

CPA Trendlines

"What AI CEO's Warning Means (and Doesn't) for Accountants" — Jul 31, 2026 (most recent issue available)

The lead piece, by Hitendra Patil, responds to a widely-circulated AI-CEO warning about job displacement, arguing accountants' work is safe — provided they're doing the right kind of work — and lays out five reasons routine compliance tasks are exposed while advisory and judgment work isn't. Companion pieces in the same issue cover a Center for Accounting Transformation panel on the "knowledge gap" this year's conference season exposed as firms try to separate real AI value from hype, a piece on standardizing firm practices as a growth lever, and a "Disruptors" interview arguing that growth naturally "breaks things" as firms scale hiring. Also flagged: an Aug 3 webinar on ERC "unfinished business" and an Aug 4 session on succession-planning frameworks.

Other Important Emails

- **Pope Golf — Colleen Miner (Corporate Controller)** — Quick-fire thread asking how to handle the new Pope Twin Isles invoice — whether Privada pays the entire bill or just its share, and confirming payment will be a mailed check since Privada can't pay via ACH — plus a related question about how a 2023 Chevy pickup purchase was originally booked. Needs your accounting guidance.
- **QuickBooks — Interstate Park Partnership LTD** — Rent invoice #14289 reminder, balance due \$2,512.36 (also copied to David@1stPropertyGroup.com).
- **Apple ID password reset** — Confirmation that the password for the dennismodrak@gmail.com Apple Account was reset — worth a quick check that this was you.
- **Todoist — new login notice** — "We noticed a new login to your Todoist account" — worth a glance if you don't recognize it.
- **Weekly Catchup (Teams invite)** — Recurring internal check-in meeting invite from max@modrakcpa.com; no specific time included in the message.

Tasks

Task	Due
Denke	Aug 2, 2026 (today)
s5	Aug 2, 2026 (today)

No overdue tasks — 2 tasks due today, pulled from Todoist.